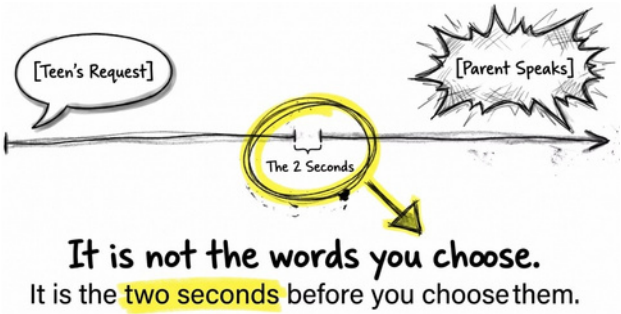
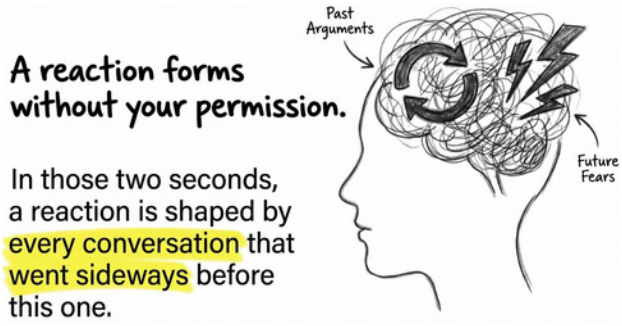
# The One Conversation Shift

**What to do in the 10 seconds before you respond to your teen.**

## Where Most Conversations Fall Apart




That is when a reaction forms without your permission; your brain gets hijacked by past arguments and future fears.




The conversation doesn't fail because of what you said. It shuts down because your teen felt **your decision had already been made.**

In those 10 seconds, ask yourself one question:

**Not:** what am I afraid might happen if I say yes.
**Not:** what did this lead to last time.
**Not:** what does this tell me about where we are headed.

**Just this: what are they asking, right now?**

## What Changes

The pause separates their request from your fear. Your teen feels the difference between a parent who already decided before they finished and a parent who is actually thinking about what they said.

| The 2-Second Reaction | The 10-Second Response |
|---|---|
| Your fear. | Their actual request. |
| They already decided before I finished. | They are actually thinking about what I said. |
| A closed door. | A teen who keeps talking. |

### The Result

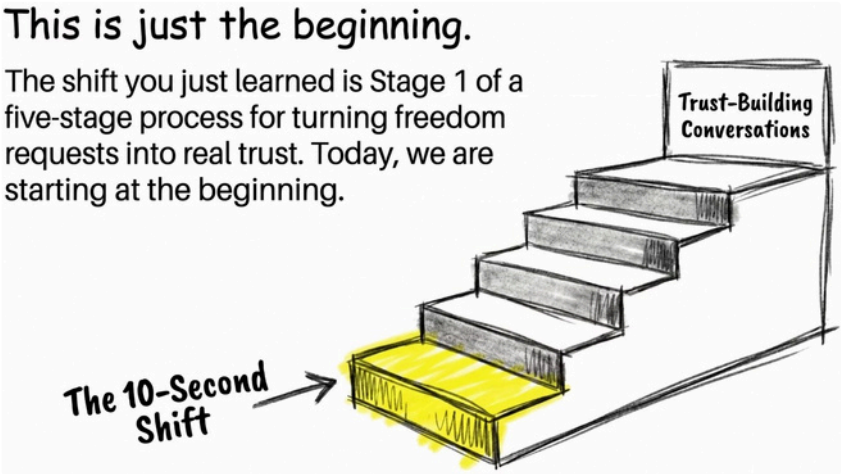
One of those parents gets a teen who **keeps talking.** The other gets a **closed door.**

### Your Challenge This Week

Pick **one conversation.** Not every conversation. One.

This week, I will pause 10 seconds the next time my teen asks about: _____

Before I respond, I will ask myself: **what is my teen actually asking right now?**




The shift above is **Stage 1** of a five-stage process for turning freedom requests into real trust-building conversations.

Today, we are starting at the beginning. Try the pause this week — there is a real conversation that this will change.

— *Jessica*

P.S. The full process, both sides of the table prepared before you sit down together, is **The Readiness Kit.** If you are ready for the whole plan, it is at thefreedomdeal.com.